Class 24 Reading Homework

Era 9: Sectionalism & Antebellum Crisis (1848– 1860) · Focus: The slave South · enslaved people's experience · free Black communities

Reading due today: AMSCO 4.12, 4.13

Connect: The 'peculiar institution' is what the Wilmot Proviso (Class 22) tried to keep OUT of new territories. Read for how the cotton economy shaped Southern society and Black life, enslaved and free.

Learning Objective(s) for today

– **4.12 (LO L):** Explain continuities and changes in the experience of African Americans from 1800 to 1848.

– **4.13 (LO M):** Explain how geographic and environmental factors shaped the development of the South from 1800 to 1848.

As you read, identify each of the following:

Terms (define in 1–2 sentences)

[ ] cotton kingdom
[ ] planter aristocracy
[ ] yeoman farmers
[ ] peculiar institution
[ ] internal slave trade
[ ] slave codes
[ ] resistance & rebellion
[ ] American Colonization Society

People (name + role/significance in 1 sentence)

[ ] Nat Turner
[ ] Denmark Vesey
[ ] David Walker
[ ] F. Douglass

Events (year + one-sentence significance)

[ ] Denmark Vesey plot (1822)
[ ] David Walker's Appeal (1829)
[ ] Nat Turner Rebellion (1831)

Reading Focus Questions

Answer in 2–4 complete sentences each. Use specific evidence from the reading.

1. Describe Southern society under slavery — who actually owned enslaved people, and how did slavery's westward expansion reshape the South?

2. Compare Nat Turner (1831), Denmark Vesey (1822), and David Walker's Appeal (1829): what did each represent about Black resistance?

3. How did free Black communities and the American Colonization Society reflect competing visions of Black futures before the Civil War?